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法老的诅咒

The Curse of the Pharaoh



法老的诅咒，经得起证据检验吗？

英文原文

On 4 November 1922, in the Valley of the Kings, **labourers engaged** by the archaeologist Howard Carter **uncovered** a **staircase carved into** the rock. On 26 November, with his **wealthy sponsor** Lord Carnarvon beside him, Carter made a small hole in the sealed **doorway** and glimpsed the **glittering** gold of the boy king Tutankhamun. The **spectacular** find **riveted** the world.

Carnarvon sold **exclusive** rights to The Times, a **monopoly** that left **competing** reporters **starved of** news. Many **resorted to speculation** or sought outside **commentators**. In March 1923 the **best-selling** novelist Marie Corelli warned publicly that **dire punishment** awaited anyone who entered a sealed **tomb**. Within a **fortnight**, her words would seem **uncanny**.

That month a **mosquito** bit Carnarvon. He **nicked** the bite with a **razor** while **shaving**, it **turned septic**, and blood poisoning led to **pneumonia**. He died in Cairo on 5 April 1923. Newspapers reported that the city's lights failed **at that instant** and that his dog in England **howled** and died. Yet **blackouts** were almost a daily **occurrence** in Cairo.

No curse **inscription** was ever found in the tomb. In December 2002 a British Medical Journal study traced the **fate** of 44 Westerners in Egypt at the time. The 25 **exposed to** the tomb died at an average age of 70, **versus** 75 for the rest, a **margin** not statistically **significant**. The **mortality** figures lent the **ominous rumour** no **credibility**.

Carnarvon's **untimely demise** had **fuelled** the tale, giving it **impetus**. Carter, the **excavator** who had **unsealed** the **burial** place, died in March 1939, aged 64, almost sixteen years after his **patron**. The legend had left him **conspicuously unharmed**.

中文译文

1922年11月4日，在帝王谷，考古学家霍华德·卡特聘用的工人，发掘出了一段雕刻在岩石上面的阶梯。11月26日，在他那富有的赞助人卡纳冯勋爵的陪同下，卡特在封住的门道上开了一个小孔，并瞥见了少年国王图坦卡蒙闪闪发光的黄金。这一惊人的/壮观的发现，牢牢吸引了全世界的注意力。

卡纳冯将独家的新闻报道权卖给了《泰晤士报》，这种垄断让相互竞争的其他记者严重缺少新闻。许多人（只能）诉诸于猜测，或者是找外界的评论员。1923年3月，畅销小说家玛丽·科雷利公开警告，极其严重的惩罚等待着任何进入封闭陵墓的人。两周之内，她的话就会显得诡异而又邪门。

当月，一只蚊子叮了卡纳冯。他刮胡子时用剃刀划破了叮咬处，伤口感染化脓了，继而血液中毒又引发了肺炎。他于1923年4月5日在开罗去世。报纸报道称，就在那一瞬间，全城（开罗）的灯都熄灭了，而他在英国的狗也嚎叫着死去了。然而，停电在当时的开罗几乎是天天都有的事情。

墓中从未发现过任何诅咒铭文。2002年12月，《英国医学杂志》的一项研究追溯了当时身在埃及的44名西方人的命运。其中曾接触这座陵墓的25人，平均死亡年龄为70岁，相比之下其余的人为75岁；这一差距在统计上并不显著。这些死亡数据让这则不祥的传言毫无可信度。

卡纳冯的过早离世助长了这一传言，并为其推波助澜。卡特，这位启封了这处墓葬的发掘者，于1939年3月去世，终年64岁，距他的资助人去世已近十六年。这个传说偏偏让他毫发无损，这一点格外醒目。

词汇与表达

labourers n.
工人

engaged v.
聘用

uncovered v.
发掘出了

staircase n.
阶梯

carved into v.
雕刻在……上面

wealthy adj.
富有的

sponsor n.
赞助人
his wealthy sponsor Lord Carnarvon

doorway n.
门道

glittering adj.
闪闪发光的

spectacular adj.
惊人的/壮观的

riveted v.
牢牢吸引了……注意力
The spectacular find riveted the world

exclusive adj.
独家的
sold exclusive rights

monopoly n.
垄断
a monopoly

competing adj.
相互竞争的

starved of v.
严重缺少
reporters starved of news

resorted to v.
诉诸于
resorted to speculation

speculation n.
猜测
resorted to speculation

commentators n.
评论员

best-selling adj.
畅销

dire adj.
极其严重的
dire punishment

punishment n.
惩罚

tomb n.
陵墓

fortnight n.
两周
Within a fortnight

uncanny adj.
诡异而又邪门
her words would seem uncanny

mosquito n.
蚊子

nicked v.
划破了

razor n.
剃刀

词汇与表达（续）

shaving n.
刮胡子

turned septic adj.
感染化脓了
it turned septic

pneumonia n.
肺炎
blood poisoning led to pneumonia

at that instant n.
在那一瞬间

howled v.
嚎叫

blackouts n.
停电

occurrence n.
事情

inscription n.
铭文
No curse inscription

fate n.
命运

exposed to adj.
接触
The 25 exposed to the tomb

versus prep.
相比之下

margin n.
差距
a margin not statistically significant

significant adj.
显著
not statistically significant

mortality n.
死亡
The mortality figures

ominous adj.
不祥的

rumour n.
传言

credibility n.
可信度
no credibility

untimely adj.
过早

demise n.
离世
Carnarvon's untimely demise

fuelled v.
助长了
had fuelled the tale

impetus n.
推波助澜
giving it impetus

excavator n.
发掘者

unsealed v.
启封了

burial n.
墓葬

patron n.
资助人

conspicuously adv.
格外醒目
conspicuously unharmed

unharmed adj.
毫发无损

文章简述

- 发现：1922年，考古学家卡特与赞助人卡纳冯打开图坦卡蒙墓，墓中珍宝震惊世界。
- 传言：卡纳冯把独家报道权卖给《泰晤士报》，其他记者转向猜测；次年他突然去世，进入墓葬会遭诅咒的故事由此盛行。
- 病因：卡纳冯剃须时划破蚊子叮咬处，伤口感染恶化，并发肺炎；报纸还说他死时开罗停电，但当地本就几乎天天停电。
- 对照：2002年一项研究比较开墓时身在埃及的44人的寿命，接触过墓的25人平均活到70岁，其余未接触者75岁；这点差异不足以排除偶然。
- 结论：墓中从未发现诅咒铭文；卡纳冯去世后，亲自开墓的卡特又活了近16年，现有证据不能证明存在诅咒。